

Pursuant to Article 14 of the Statute of Algebra Bernays University, the Senate of Algebra Bernays University enacted at its 28th session, held on 20th February 2026, the following

BOOK OF REGULATIONS ON THE FINAL, GRADUATION OR SPECIALIST THESIS AND THE FINAL EXAM

1. GENERAL PROVISIONS

Article 1

- (1) The Book of Regulations on the Final, Graduation or Specialist Thesis and the Final Exam (hereinafter: *Book of Regulations*) shall regulate the terms and methods of registration, approval, preparation, defence and evaluation of the final, graduation or specialist thesis, and the methods of registration and evaluation of the final exam at Algebra Bernays University.

Article 2

- (1) In order to obtain a certificate of the completed professional short-cycle study programme or a diploma of the completed professional undergraduate study programme, professional graduate study programme, university undergraduate study programme or university graduate study programme at Algebra Bernays University, it is necessary for the student, in addition to passing exams and completing other obligations, to enrol in the module in which the final, graduation or specialist thesis is done, and to successfully defend the final, graduation or specialist thesis on the final exam, in accordance with the provisions of the Statute of Algebra Bernays University and the provisions of this Book of Regulations.

2. FINAL, GRADUATION OR SPECIALIST THESIS

Article 3

- (1) The final, graduation or specialist thesis represents an independent professional processing of the established subject as defined by this Book of Regulations and the Registration Form for the Subject of the Final, Graduation or Specialist Thesis.
- (2) In the preparation of the final, graduation or specialist thesis, the student should demonstrate the ability to apply theoretical and practical knowledge and skills as well as the ability to utilize professional and scientific literature in an independent manner for the purpose of solving problems related to their profession, in accordance with the degree of expertise acquired at the study programme.
- (3) The final, graduation or specialist thesis does not have to possess the quality of an original work, but it must be prepared independently by the student.

- (4) The final thesis must be written on a topic in student's field of expertise.
- (5) The final, graduation or specialist thesis may be prepared at Algebra Bernays University through collaboration with a mentor or head of a university department or at one of the workplaces of Algebra Bernays University or at the company chosen by the student and accepted by Algebra Bernays University as the place of the preparation of the final, graduation or specialist thesis.

3. FINAL AND GRADUATION THESES COMMITTEE

Article 4

- (1) The Final and Graduation Theses Committee (hereinafter: *Committee*) shall monitor the quality of the final theses and graduation theses written by students.
- (2) The Committee shall consist of the Committee Chairman, all heads of university departments, all heads of academic units, five members responsible for maintaining an adequate academic level and a Coordinator for Final and Graduation Theses (hereinafter: *Coordinator*).
- (3) The Committee performs its duties through five field committees, which are organized as follows:
 - a. field committee for computing,
 - b. field committee for economics and marketing,
 - c. field committee for graphic technology and design,
 - d. field committee for communication sciences,
 - e. field committee for MBA.
- (4) The Committee Chairman and the members responsible for maintaining an adequate academic level shall be appointed by the Senate for a mandate that lasts until impeachment.
- (5) The Coordinator is a staff member of the Office for Academic Support.
- (6) The Committee Chairman, by decision, allocates members of the Committee to field committees.
- (7) The Coordinator assists the Committee Chairman with administrative tasks related to final and graduation theses and conducts meetings of the field committees.
- (8) The Committee Chairman shall, at the end of their term of office, prepare a report for the Committee for Quality Assurance on the work of the Final and Graduation Theses Committee.

4. SELECTION OF MENTORS

Article 5

- (1) A mentor may be a teacher at Algebra Bernays University appointed to a position or a nominal position according to the criteria of the position.

- (2) No later than 90 days from the beginning of the semester preceding the semester in which the module with the final, graduation or specialist thesis is held, the Committee compiles a list of potential mentors that students can choose in the respective academic year. The list is published within the digital student service system as part of a subsystem for the registration of the final, graduation or specialist thesis.
- (3) Within the deadline determined by the Committee Chairman by way of publication within the digital student service system, the student shall apply for the appointment of a mentor. Thereby, the student shall propose a mentor and the subject field wherein they wish to prepare the final or graduation thesis.
- (4) Student applications and proposals for general subject fields for mentorship shall be sent automatically to the proposed potential mentors, through the digital student service system. The potential mentors shall provide a response by accepting or rejecting the mentorship of an individual student no later than 15 working days following the deadline for the selection of mentors given to the students.
- (5) The responses from potential mentors shall not be available to students, but to the Committee Chairman, who shall proceed to conduct the procedure for the selection and appointment of mentors for all students who have registered for the preparation of the final, graduation or specialist thesis.
- (6) If the student's application should not be accepted by the proposed mentor, the Committee Chairman shall appoint a mentor for the student.
- (7) The Committee Chairman shall, when appointing mentors to students, pay attention to the optimal distribution of mentorship and, if possible, respect the choice of the student and the confirmation of the selected mentor regarding their readiness to take on mentorship of an individual student.
- (8) Students shall be informed about the selection of mentors through the digital student service system and shall be invited to consult with the mentor on the exact subject, aim and content of the thesis to be proposed to the Committee.
- (9) Exceptionally, it is possible to assign a co-mentor to the paper, in the following situations:
 - a. if the topic of the paper is interdisciplinary,
 - b. if the mentor decides to involve one of the assistants in administrative-technical activities related to the preparation of the paper,
 - c. if the mentor decides to include an expert in the field of the topic, in order to contribute to the quality of the work with their knowledge and experience
- (10) If the topic of the paper is interdisciplinary, the co-mentor should be appointed to a position or a nominal position according to the criteria of the position in the field being co-mentored.

- (11) If the co-mentor is designated by the mentor for administrative-technical support in the preparation of the paper, the co-mentor should be a person who has participated in the teaching process at Algebra Bernays University within the last year.
- (12) The proposal for the assignment of a co-mentor is submitted to the Final and Graduation Theses Committee in writing in addition to the Registration Form for the Subject of the Final, Graduation or Specialist Thesis. The proposal must state the name and surname of the person proposed as a co-mentor, an explanation of why the person is proposed as a co-mentor and what exactly will be the role and task of the co-mentor during the preparation of the final, graduation or specialist thesis.
- (13) For students who fail to complete the form for the selection of mentors within the digital student service system within the prescribed deadline, it shall be considered that they do not want to enrol in the module in which the final, graduation or specialist thesis is done in the current academic year, and the selection of a mentor, i.e. enrolment of that module shall be performed in some of the following academic years. The student's right to select a mentor shall be valid for as long as the student should hold their student rights.

5. THESIS SUBJECT DEFINITION AND APPROVAL

Article 6

- (1) The student shall engage with the mentor in defining the thesis subject.
- (2) The thesis subject must correspond to the level of the study programme and must reflect the professional quality of the study programme with particular focus on the elaboration of a specific practical task. Only in exceptional cases, if the Final and Graduation Theses Committee should allow it, can the thesis subject be of theoretical nature.
- (3) The thesis subject must be related to the student's field of expertise.
- (4) The defined thesis subject must be described in detail by way of the Registration Form for the Subject of the Final, Graduation or Specialist Thesis, which the mentor shall submit to the Committee for approval.

Article 7

- (1) The Committee shall consider and approve the proposed thesis subjects at the sessions of the appropriate field committee, which are organized once a month in all months except July and August.
- (2) The mentor and the student, whose subject proposals are being discussed, are invited to the field committee sessions. In case the mentor does not come to the session, the committee is allowed to not discuss the proposed subject or postpone the discussion of the proposed subject to the next session.

- (3) The field committee may confirm the proposed subject, request necessary amendments to the proposed subject or reject the proposed subject. In the case of a subject rejection, the student and the selected mentor should propose another subject, in accordance with the remarks and recommendation made by the field committee.
- (4) The completed Registration Form for the Subject of the Final, Graduation or Specialist Thesis is archived in the final or graduation theses digital archive.
- (5) The Coordinator keeps minutes of the session of the field committee and delivers the minutes to all members of the Committee and to all mentors whose subject proposals were considered at the session.

Article 8

- (1) The student may change their mentor, thesis subject or both once in an academic year.
- (2) In case the student should change the thesis subject with the same mentor, a completed Registration Form for the Subject of the Final, Graduation or Specialist Thesis should be submitted for the new proposed subject along with a request for a change of the subject.
- (3) In case the student should change the mentor, the new mentor must be from the current list of mentors. By choosing a new mentor, it is possible to choose a new thesis subject, and following the approval of the change of the mentor, it is necessary to submit the Registration Form for the Subject of the Final, Graduation or Specialist Thesis.
- (4) Students who wish to retain the approved thesis subject should be provided with a written consent from the new mentor accepting the mentorship for that thesis subject.
- (5) The change of the mentor shall be approved by the Committee Chairman, and the new proposed subject shall be approved by the Committee.
- (6) Part-time students, as well as students who are scholarship holders or loan beneficiaries, may choose a thesis subject in accordance with the needs of the company, scholarship provider or loan provider.

Article 9

- (1) At the beginning of each summer semester, the Committee Chairman shall be obliged to establish the exact schedule of deadlines related to the final or graduation theses and publish it under the teaching materials section of the modules in which the final, graduation or specialist thesis is done.

6. PREPARATION OF THE FINAL, GRADUATION OR SPECIALIST THESIS

Article 10

- (1) When preparing the thesis, the student shall be obliged to adhere to the subject approved by the Committee, accepting and respecting all remarks and suggestions received from the Committee.
- (2) The mentor shall be responsible for ensuring that the thesis is prepared in accordance with the approved subject.
- (3) The scope and complexity of the subject of the final, graduation or specialist thesis must correspond to the level of the study programme and must be such that the student can prepare it within the period corresponding to the enrolled ECTS points (1 ECTS point = 25-30 working hours).
- (4) The final thesis must include 12,000-15,000 words from the introduction to the conclusion.
- (5) The graduation or specialist thesis must include 20,000-25,000 words from the introduction to the conclusion.

Article 11

- (1) If a student should prepare a thesis in an external company during their internship, they shall be appointed a thesis coordinator in addition to a mentor, who shall be in charge of monitoring and assisting their work and who shall be in constant contact and coordination with the mentor, in accordance with the Book of Regulations on Internship.
- (2) The specification of the tasks pertaining to the thesis coordinator, and the rights and obligations of the student during the internship, shall be defined by a special agreement between Algebra Bernays University and the individual workplace where the student should conduct their internship, in accordance with the Book of Regulations on Internship.

Article 12

- (1) The final thesis shall be written in standard Croatian or English language, and in Latin script.
- (2) The graduation thesis shall be written in standard English language, and in Latin script.
- (3) The specialist thesis shall be written in standard Croatian or English language, and in Latin script.
- (4) A complete example of the textual form of the final, graduation or specialist thesis with all font sizes and shapes used in the final, graduation or specialist thesis can be found in the electronic template (Appendix 1), which is available to students within the digital student service system. The student must prepare a final, graduation or specialist thesis as established in the template (Appendix 1), respecting all the provisions and parts under the template.

- (5) The final thesis for the professional undergraduate study programme Market Communication Design consists of a written part that should be designed in accordance with the instructions for the design of the final theses in the professional study programme Market Communication Design (Appendix 2) and visual templates or digital works created by the student independently.
- (6) In exceptional cases, at the interdisciplinary graduate study programme Creative Market Communications Management, the topic of the final thesis can be visual-communication oriented, whereby the work is designed as prescribed for the professional undergraduate study programme Market Communication Design in the previous Paragraph.

Article 13

- (1) As an integral part of the final, graduation or specialist thesis, the student needs to sign the following statement:

"Under full responsibility, I confirm in writing that this is my original work, no part therein created by copying or plagiarising the content of a third party nor by generating using AI tools. In preparing the thesis, I used materials from third parties listed in the bibliography, but I did not copy any of their parts, except for quotations for which I cited the author and source and clearly marked them with quotation marks. In the event that the contrary is proven at any time, I am ready to bear all the consequences, including the annulment of the public document acquired in part and on the basis of this paper."

- (2) The statement from Paragraph 1 of this Article, with the specified meta-data about the thesis, is signed by the student by hand in front of the Examination Panel during the thesis defence.

Article 14

- (1) During the preparation of the thesis, the student shall be obliged to accept the remarks made by the mentor, co-mentor, or thesis coordinator and perform the required modifications and refinements, respecting the provisions of this Book of Regulations.
- (2) In case that the thesis prepared for submission should fail to meet quality and scope standards in the opinion of the mentor or it should fail to convene with the subject approved by the Committee, the thesis shall be returned to the student for amending.

7. SUBMISSION OF THE THESIS

Article 15

- (1) In case that the student has prepared one or more works which in their content and scope correspond to the final, graduation or specialist thesis during the study programme, and the works were not a prerequisite for obtaining a signature or a certain number of points at one of the modules enrolled in and attended by the student, the student may submit that work instead of submitting the Thesis

Registration Form, and the Committee may recognize the work as the final, graduation or specialist thesis by a majority vote.

- (2) By the same procedure, the Committee may also recognize an invention, technical improvement, published professional or scientific paper and the like as a final, graduation or specialist thesis if it should correspond in content to a final, graduation or specialist thesis. In that case, the procedure for registering and submitting the final, graduation or specialist thesis shall be identical to the procedure described in this Book of Regulations.

Article 16

- (1) The student shall send the completed thesis with all attachments to the mentor in a digital form. The completed written part of the thesis needs to be delivered in Word format.
- (2) After the mentor assesses that the delivered thesis is satisfactory in terms of its quality and scope, the mentor sends the thesis to the Coordinator. The thesis should be submitted to the Coordinator no later than 28 days before the desired deadline for the registration of the thesis defence.
- (3) The coordinator determines whether the thesis meets all technical requirements. If the thesis does not meet all technical requirements, it is returned for revision to the mentor and the student.
- (4) A thesis that meets all technical requirement must be checked with plagiarism checker software and together with a plagiarism checker software report is delivered to the Examination Panel.

8. EXAMINATION PANEL AND THE THESIS GRADING

Article 17

- (1) The Final and Graduation Theses Committee Chairman shall determine the composition of the Examination Panel for each student separately, after the mentor submits the completed thesis to the Coordinator.
- (2) The Examination Panel shall consist of the following members: Examination Panel Chairman, mentor and a member.
- (3) Members of the Examination Panel may also be members of the Final and Graduation Theses Committee.
- (4) A member of the Examination Panel, in addition to the mentor, shall be an expert from the ranks of teachers at Algebra Bernays University appointed to a position or a nominal position according to the criteria of the position.

Article 18

- (1) The Examination Panel examines the final, graduation or specialist thesis and submits its comments to the Coordinator and the student within a maximum of 15 days from the submission of the thesis.

- (2) As an exception to Paragraph 1 of this Article, the deadline for evaluating theses submitted to the Coordinator from July 1st to August 15th shall be September 1st.
- (3) The Examination Panel determines whether the thesis corresponds to the approved subject registration form, whether there are parts of the thesis that threaten the originality of the work (based on the plagiarism checker report) and it determines the quality and scope of the thesis. If the members of the Examination Panel consider that the thesis is at a satisfactory level but have comments, they provide them to the mentor and the student. The student then revises the thesis based on the comments. If the Examination Panel determines that the thesis is not at a satisfactory level, the student is directed to revise the entire thesis and resubmit it to the mentor and the Panel.
- (4) A student whose thesis is at a satisfactory level but requires minimal corrections according to the comments of the Examination Panel must correct and proofread the thesis before final submission. The mentor submits the corrected and proofread version of the thesis, along with a proofreading certificate signed by the proofreader, to the Coordinator. This version of the thesis is considered the final version and is submitted in PDF format.
- (5) A student whose thesis is at a satisfactory level and does not require any corrections must proofread the thesis before final submission. The mentor submits the proofread version of the thesis, along with a proofreading certificate signed by the proofreader, to the Coordinator. This version of the thesis is considered the final version and is submitted in PDF format.
- (6) An evaluation of the written part of the thesis shall be provided by each member of the Examination Panel by way of entry into the designated place within the digital student service system.
- (7) A proofreader can be a person with at least an undergraduate degree in the language in which the thesis is written, or a person who has worked as a proofreader for at least one year, which is proven by a certificate from their employer.

9. FINAL EXAM AND THESIS DEFENCE

Article 19

- (1) The prerequisite for registering for the defence of the final, graduation or specialist thesis shall be the active student status, all exams passed within the enrolled study programme, an approved Registration Form for the Subject of the Final, Graduation or Specialist Thesis, a submitted final version of the thesis and fulfilled all other established student obligations, confirmed by the assigned signatures of the responsible persons within the digital student service system.
- (2) Students of undergraduate and professional short-cycle study programmes must, in addition to the requirements from Paragraph 1 of this Article, have registered and completed an internship, if it is prescribed by the study programme.

Article 20

- (1) The Coordinator shall establish the date of the thesis defence in agreement with all members of the Examination Panel, and no later than 15 days from the registration date for the final, graduation or specialist thesis defence.
- (2) In exceptional cases, the date of the thesis defence may be established no later than 30 days from the registration date for the thesis defence.

Article 21

- (1) The thesis defence shall be public and shall take place before the Examination Panel, students, teachers and other interested parties. In accordance with the qualities of the defence proceedings, Algebra Bernays University shall ensure the requirements for a solemn atmosphere during the defence. Students shall be expected to make their contribution to this important act with their performance and solemn appearance.
- (2) The procedure and evaluation at the thesis defence shall be carried out by the Examination Panel.
- (3) The student shall present their work at the defence, and the Examination Panel shall check their knowledge in a narrower scope of the thesis subject field.

Article 22

- (1) The procedure for the thesis defence is as follows:
 - a. The Examination Panel Chairman shall open the procedure (present Examination Panel members and the students and establish the fulfilment of all prerequisites for the exam registration and thesis defence and explain the defence procedure to the student).
 - b. The student shall present the basic problematics examined in the thesis, the methods used and the most important results achieved in the work. The student's presentation can last up to 20 minutes on undergraduate and professional short-cycle study programmes, and up to 30 minutes on graduate study programmes.
 - c. Following the presentation of the thesis, the Examination Panel members pose questions to the student pertaining to a narrower scope of the thesis subject field.
 - d. The student shall answer these questions.
 - e. After the student has answered all the questions, they shall leave the room wherein only the members of the Examination Panel should remain.
 - f. After consultations, the Examination Panel reaches a consensus on the grade for the thesis defence and shall summon the student to communicate the final grade and the explanation to it to the student.

Article 23

- (1) The thesis grade, the thesis defence grade and accordingly the grade of the final exam can be: insufficient (1), sufficient (2), good (3), very good (4) and excellent (5).
- (2) All members of the Examination Panel shall decide on the thesis defence grade based on the criteria defined for the evaluation of the thesis defence.
- (3) The final grade of the final exam, which is also the final grade of the study programme, shall be determined in accordance with the formula $(4A+B+C)/6$, wherein A is the grade point average of all passed exams during the study programme, B the thesis grade, and C the thesis defence grade. The final evaluation of the success of the study programme should be rounded to the nearest integer.
- (4) The final thesis defence grade may be insufficient if the student should receive the grade insufficient in any evaluation segment (the thesis or the thesis defence) at the final exam, i.e. thesis defence. In case that the final thesis defence grade should be insufficient (1), an explanation for such grade must be stated and entered in the minutes of the final exam.
- (5) In case that the student should register but fails to defend the thesis, the Examination Panel shall advise them to re-enrol in the module.

Article 24

- (1) Final exam minutes shall be kept through the digital student service system, wherein the grades, names of the Examination Panel members, thesis subject and the date of the defence shall be stated.
- (2) A copy of the final exam minutes shall be printed from the digital student service and signed by all Examination Panel members. The signed minutes shall be submitted by the Examination Panel Chairman to the Coordinator.
- (3) The Coordinator shall keep records on the thesis defences. The final exam minutes shall be archived and kept in accordance with the rules on archiving and storage of acts of permanent value within the student profile.
- (4) The final version of the thesis is published in the digital academic archives system and repositories of the Republic of Croatia, through which it is publicly available. The document published shall contain:
 - a. a confirmation of assignment of the final, graduation or specialist thesis subject, signed by the Committee Chairman, the mentor and the student,
 - b. the final, graduation or specialist thesis itself,
 - c. a statement of academic integrity, signed by the student,
 - d. final exam minutes, signed by all members of the Examination Panel.

10. GRADUATION CEREMONY AND THE ISSUANCE OF DOCUMENTATION ON THE COMPLETION OF THE STUDY PROGRAMME

Article 25

- (1) After the expiration of a minimum of 5 working days after the defence of the thesis, the student may collect the certificate of completion of studies which is issued upon the student's request.
- (2) The certificate of completion of studies is a public document and its purpose is to prove the status until the issuance of the diploma or the certificate.

11. TRANSITIONAL AND FINAL PROVISIONS

Article 26

- (1) The Senate of Algebra Bernays University resolves complaints and appeals of students related to the final or graduation theses, as well as the final exam.

Article 27

- (1) All general provisions related to final and graduation theses and final exams must be aligned with this Book of Regulations no later than 6 months from the date of its entry into force.
- (2) An integral part of this Book of Regulations are: the Final, Graduation or Specialist Thesis Template (Annex 1), Instructions for the design of final theses in the study programme Market Communication Design (Appendix 2).

Article 28

- (1) This Book of Regulations enters into force on the day of its adoption and applies to all students of Algebra Bernays University.

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